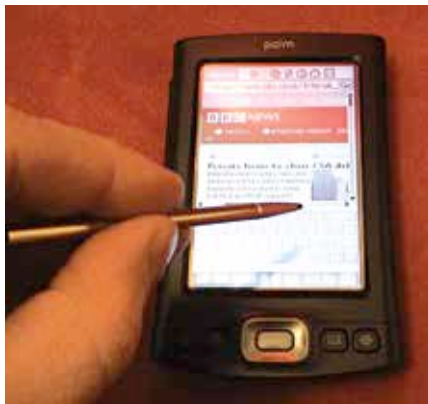


tems to control operations. As the technology became more advanced, the first touch system OS was introduced for the PDA or 'computer'. They usually needed a stylus for interaction and the interface was clunky and impractical.



An old Palm computer being used with a stylus

Symbian was the first modern mobile OS on a smartphone with the launch of Ericsson R380. Around this time, Blackberries were excessively popular and touch phones were thought to be a hassle to use. Typing on the touch phones just wasn't as efficient as typing on a phone with physical keys. That changed when Android OS was introduced in 2008 with the HTC Dream (T-G1). This came just after

the launch of the new Apple product called 'iPhone' (We know how that story goes) and after this point, there was just no looking back.

Android was a game-changer as it offered consumers as well as manufacturers something rare and unique. Android is an OS which relies on touch, multitouch and gestures like swiping and tapping. However, you would be mistaken in thinking that Android and Google are one and the same. They are now, but Android was not developed by Google.

Let's go for a short history lesson and have a look at this newspaper clipping from 2005;

*August 17, 2005*

*By Ben Elgin*

*Business Week*

*In what could be a key move in its nascent wireless strategy, Google has quietly acquired startup Android Inc., BusinessWeek Online has learned. The 22-month-old startup, based in Palo Alto, Calif., brings to Google a wealth of talent, including co-founder Andy Rubin, who previously started mobile-device maker Danger Inc.'*

In one of the the most important deals it made, Google acquired Android and all rights to market it as the mobile OS of the future. It was time to usher in the generation of touch phones. And every vendor wanted in. This deal